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AI Fluency

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Learning Objective

Based on Anthropic's online course – *AI Fluency: Framework & Foundation*

By the end of this session, you should be able to:

- Understand AI fluency as a broader capability than prompting alone
- Explain and apply the **4D AI Fluency Framework** to a multi-step task
- Collaborate with AI more *effectively*, *efficiently*, *ethically*, and *safely*
- Understand in plain language how prompts, workflows, skills, MCP, and agents represent different ways of structuring AI use
- Reflect on your own approach to working with AI in study and managerial practice

Opening

1) How do you use AI in daily life?

   What tasks do you use AI for? Study? Writing? Translation? Planning? Coding? Search?

2) How do you usually interact with AI?

   - **Passive:** ask one question → accept the answer
   - **Engaged:** ask for a summary, explanation, or ideas → read it over
   - **Iterative:** ask → review → refine the prompt → ask again
   - **Delegating:** break a task into steps → direct AI through each one → verify the result

Translate this

Reply this email

Write me a research proposal about AI's impact on business

What Is AI Fluency

What it is not	What it is
Memorize prompt templates	A mindset – how you think about AI
Learn platform-specific shortcut	A collaboration skill – how you think with AI
Get better output by trial and error	A grounding framework for human–AI work
A skill that expires when tool change	A transferable capability that lasts

***AI fluency** means using AI in ways that are:*

Effective
Get the right outcome

Efficient
Use times & effort well

Ethical
Keep humans in the loop

Safe
Avoid harm & misuse

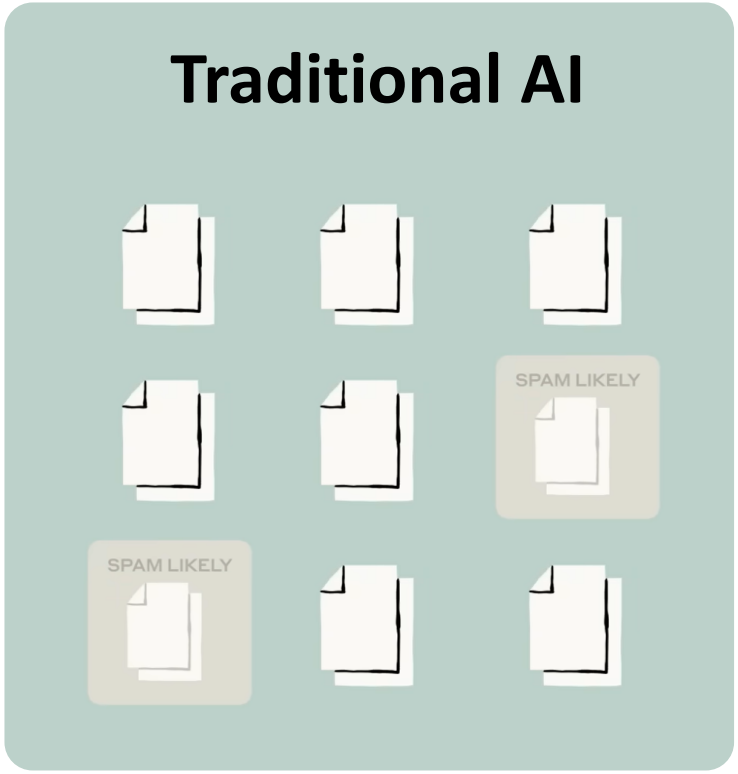
"Prompt engineering may change quickly — AI fluency is the more stable capability."

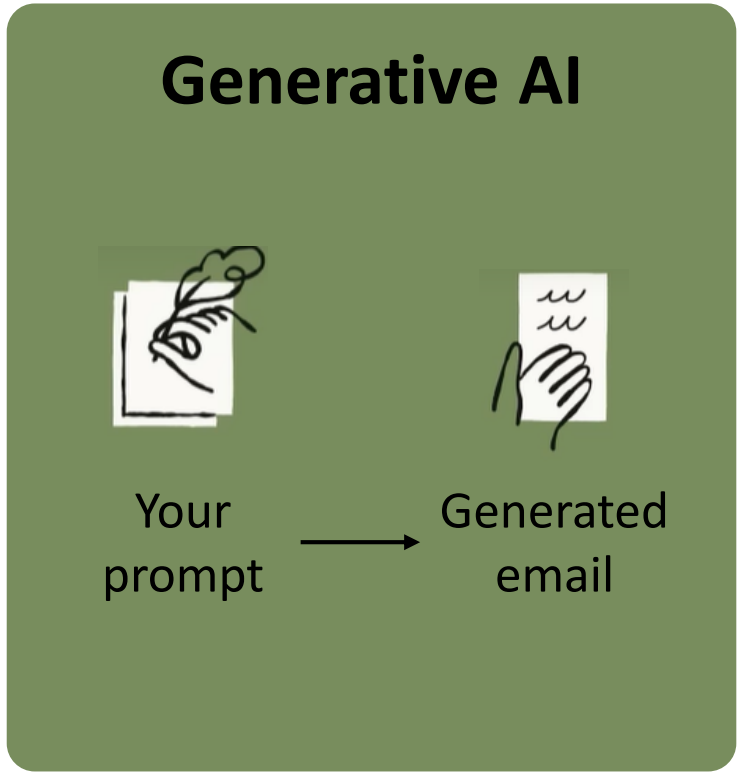
Why We Need AI Fluency

All “story” begin here

- Statistical pattern
- Predict the next word

What is Generative AI?





Why We Need AI Fluency

All “story” begin here

Three pillars that made generative AI possible

Algorithms

- Neural networks
- Transformers

Data

- Articles and websites
- Code and multimodal content

Computation

- GPUs, TPUs, etc.
- Computing clusters

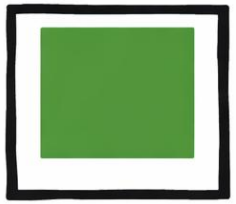
Why We Need AI Fluency

All “story” begin here

Limitations of Generative AI

Knowledge cutoff date

Hallucination



AI context window

Non-deterministic output

抽卡

Reasoning limitation

Why We Need AI Fluency

Humans provide

- Critical thinking
- Judgment
- Creativity
- Ethical oversight

AI provides

- Speed
- Scale
- Pattern recognition
- Processing abilities

Three Ways to Collaborate with AI

MODE 1

Automation

You instruct. AI executes.

BEST FOR

- Repetitive or formulaic tasks
- Format, summarize, clean

USE WHEN

- Goal is clear and narrow
- Output is easy to verify

MODE 2

Augmentation

You and AI think together.

BEST FOR

- Brainstorm & problem solve
- Refine ideas or approaches

USE WHEN

- Task needs iteration & judgment
- You want feedback or alternatives

MODE 3

Agency

You configure. AI acts.

BEST FOR

- Multi-step or recurring workflows
- Systems that act on your behalf
- Scheduled or automated pipelines

USE WHEN

- Process is well-defined with guardrails
- You are ready to monitor outcomes

AI Fluency Framework

When should human do work, and when should AI

Delegation

How do we communicate clearly with AI?

Description

Discernment

How do we evaluate what AI gives us?

Diligence

How do we ensure our interactions with AI is responsible, transparent, and accountable?

Delegation

- Understanding the problem you're trying to solve
- Understanding the capabilities of available AI tools
- Breaking down complex work into smaller parts
- Making strategies decisions about who does what
- Choosing the right mode of interaction

Delegation

Problem Awareness

The ability to clearly define your goals and understand what work is needed before involving AI tools

- What does “success” look like
- What kind of thinking and work is needed to get there?
- AI fluency begins with and depends on your expertise

Platform Awareness

A working knowledge of available AI systems and their specific capabilities and limitations

- Understand the unique strengths and limitations of available options
- Which models perform best for your task?
- Which system prioritize speed, or creativity, or depth, or accuracy

Task Delegation

The strategic process of dividing work between humans and AI

- What could be usefully automated?
- Where would augmentation create more values than working separately?
- What would be done by a human alone?
- What could be done by an agent on your behalf?

Exercise – Applications of the 4D Framework

Your team task for this session

Choose one workflow or process that could be improved with AI

Example workflows

- Customer complaint handling
- Employee onboarding
- Candidate screening
- Sales lead qualification
- Supplier communication
- Internal report drafting

Final group artifact

A concise **management recommendation** that includes:

- Workflow and problem
- AI role and human role
- Revised AI-assisted draft
- Diligence statement

Exercise – Delegation

Task: Choose one workflow and discuss it with AI before asking for an answer.

Discuss with your group and AI

- What is the overall goal?
- What does a good result look like?
- What are the major tasks involved?
- **Which tasks need more**
  - human judgment
  - human expertise
  - human accountability
- Which tasks could AI support well?
- **Which collaboration mode fits best**
  - Automation
  - Augmentation
  - agency

Your output

Prepare a simple delegation plan:

- workflow / process
- goal
- major tasks
- human-led tasks
- AI-assisted tasks
- tasks not suitable for AI

Description

Don’t just craft prompts

Explain tasks, ask questions, provide context, and guide the interaction

Build a **shared thinking environment** where both you and the AI can each do your best work

Description

Product Description

The ability to clearly define the characteristics of your desired output

- Clear describe what you want
- Context, format, audience, style, and other constraints
- Give AI the information it needs to deliver what you're actually looking for, not just assuming what you want

Process Description

The ability to guide the AI's thought process

- "How" can be more important than "What"
- Providing training specific to your problem
- Specific data, key tasks, preferred order, and so on

Performance Description

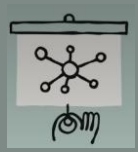
The ability to define the behavioral aspects of an AI interaction

- AI tools are interactive systems that can behave differently in different contexts
- You need to explain how you want the AI to behave to get the best results

Effective Prompting Techniques

Ask the AI for help with prompting

Provide context



Offer examples

Specify output constraints

Break down complex tasks

Give the AI space to think

Define roles

Effective Prompting Techniques

Patterns that work well

- Starting with a clear task overview statement
- Introducing output format specifications and examples
- Detailing specific task constraints or requirements
- Providing rich and relevant background information

Common mistakes to avoid

- Assuming AI can read your mind
- Overloading a single prompt or conversation with multiple unrelated tasks
- Being too vague about what success looks like
- Not providing feedback on previous responses

Exercise – Description

Task: turn your delegation plan into a strong AI request

Your prompt should include

- **Product**: what output you want
- **Process**: how AI should approach the task
- **Performance**: how AI should behave during collaboration

Prompt template

You are helping a management team improve [workflow/process].
Context: …
Goal: …
Audience: …
Please produce: …
Format: …
Constraints: …
When making assumptions, state them clearly.
Do not invent facts or company data.
Ask clarifying questions if key information is missing.

Your output

- one improved prompt
- one AI-generated first draft of your management recommendation

Discernment

Your ability to critically evaluate what AI produces, how it produces it and how it behaves

You need

Domain expertise + taste

An understanding of how AI systems work and their typical shortcomings

Discernment

Product Discernment

Your capacity to judge the quality of the AI output

- Factually accurate?
- Appropriate to audience and purpose?
- Coherent and well-structured?
- Does it meet my requirements?
- Does it add values?

Process Discernment

Your capability to judge the quality of the problem solving approach

- Logical inconsistency
- Lapses in attention
- Inappropriate steps
- Getting stuck on one small detail
- Getting trapped in circular reasoning

Performance Discernment

Your capability to judge AI behaviors

- Is the communication styles appropriate?
- Is the information at the right level?
- Is response to feedback appropriate?
- Is the interaction efficient?

Exercise – Discernment

Task: Review the AI output your group received. Treat it as a draft that requires evaluation, not as a finished answer.

Product discernment

- Is it accurate?
- Is it relevant to the workflow?
- Is it clear and well-structured?
- Does it actually solve the problem?

Process discernment

- Is the reasoning logical?
- Are there missing steps or weak assumptions?
- Is the recommendation too broad or superficial?

Performance discernment

- Was the response at the right level for managers?
- Was the tone and style useful?
- Did the AI follow your instructions well?

Your output

- Create a short review: keep, revise, reject
- Revise your prompt or instructions once and improve the draft

Diligence

Taking responsibility

Rigorous, transparent, and accountable

Consider broader questions

Responsibility starts with awareness

Diligence

Creation Diligence

Your ability to be critical and intentional about which AI systems you choose to use and how you use them

- The AI systems that we use
- How we work with them
- The impacts that come from that interaction

Transparency Diligence

Your ability to be open and accurate about AI interaction with relevant stakeholders

- Who needs to know?
- How should I communicate this?
- What level of detail is needed?

Deployment Diligence

Your capability to take informed responsibility for the outputs your use or share after they've been created with AI assistance

- Verify facts
- Check for biases
- Ensure accuracy
- Check for usage rights
- And so on …

Diligence

Ethical Frameworks

- Personal guidelines
- Organizational policies
- Professional standards
- Industry codes of conduct
- Legal and regulatory frameworks
- Staying informed

ANTHROP\C

AI Diligence Statement

In the development of the AI Fluency: Framework and Foundations course, we engaged in extensive collaboration with Claude 3.7 from Anthropic.

The base content for this course came from:

- The AI Fluency Framework Practical Summary Document by Rick Dakan (at Ringling College of Art and Design) and Joseph Feller (at University College Cork) and related working documents and research notes
- Slide decks and lecture transcripts from multiple university courses, guest lectures, and research talks delivered by Feller and/or Dakan
- Technical/practical content provided by Maggie Vo and Drew Bent (Anthropic)

Throughout this process, Claude assisted one or more of the human authors with structural development, resource and exercise design, and content drafting, critiquing, editing and rewriting. The human authors wrote, designed, edited and provided continual vision, expertise, critical judgment, and domain knowledge and made all final decisions about both content and approach.

All AI-generated and co-created content underwent thorough validation, editing, and curation by the human authors. The final materials accurately reflect the human authors' understanding, expertise, and intended pedagogical approach. While AI assistance was instrumental in producing these materials, the human authors maintain responsibility for the content.

This disclosure is made in the spirit of transparency advocated by the AI Fluency Framework and to acknowledge the evolving role of AI in educational content development and other creative and intellectual work.

Exercise – Diligence

Creation diligence

- Which AI system did you use, and why?
- What information did you share?
- Any privacy, security, or ethical concerns?

Transparency diligence

- If this were submitted in class or used at work, what should be disclosed?
- How did AI contribute to the work?

Deployment diligence

- What still needs verification?
- What claims should not be used without checking?
- What responsibility remains with the human team?

Your output

Draft a short diligence statement

Include:

- What AI helped with
- How the group reviewed and revised the output
- What responsibility the group retains

From Prompts to Agents

From Prompts to Agents

These concepts all build on the same core interaction: **giving AI instructions and context to make outputs more useful and reliable**. What changes is the scope being structured — one request, a repeatable method, a workflow, or a larger work environment.

Prompting	Workflows	Skills	MCP	Agents
shape one request	shape a sequence of steps	reuse a proven method	connect AI to tools and data	let AI carry out multi-step work

Two newer ideas sit across that ladder:

Context engineering	Decide what information, instructions, and tools the model should see at each step.
Harness engineering	Design the broader environment around the model: memory, tools, checks, feedback loops, and human review.

Takeaway: do not chase buzzwords. Ask which level of structure your task actually needs.

From Prompts to Agents

Agent Skills with Anthropic

蒸馏同事 → 同事.skill

Prompting

One request, one response

Best for quick drafting, summarizing, brainstorming, or clarifying one task.

Example: "Summarize this report in 5 bullets."

Workflows

A sequence of steps

Best when the work includes multiple stages, handoffs, or revisions.

Example: collect data → analyze → draft → human review.

Skills

A reusable method

Best for recurring tasks where you want consistency across many conversations.

Example: a standard method for analyzing customer complaints.

A prompt is one question. A workflow is a process. A skill is a reusable recipe inside that process.

From Prompts to Agents

When AI needs external systems and multi-step action

MCP Model Context Protocol

A standard way for AI applications to connect to files, databases, APIs, search tools, calendars, and other systems.

- files
- database
- search
- calendar

Agent AI configured for multi-step work

An agent can plan, use tools, check results, and continue in a loop — instead of answering only once.

Plan › Use tool › Check result › Continue / stop

Without connections, AI mostly talks. With MCP and agent design, AI can access systems and carry out longer tasks more usefully.

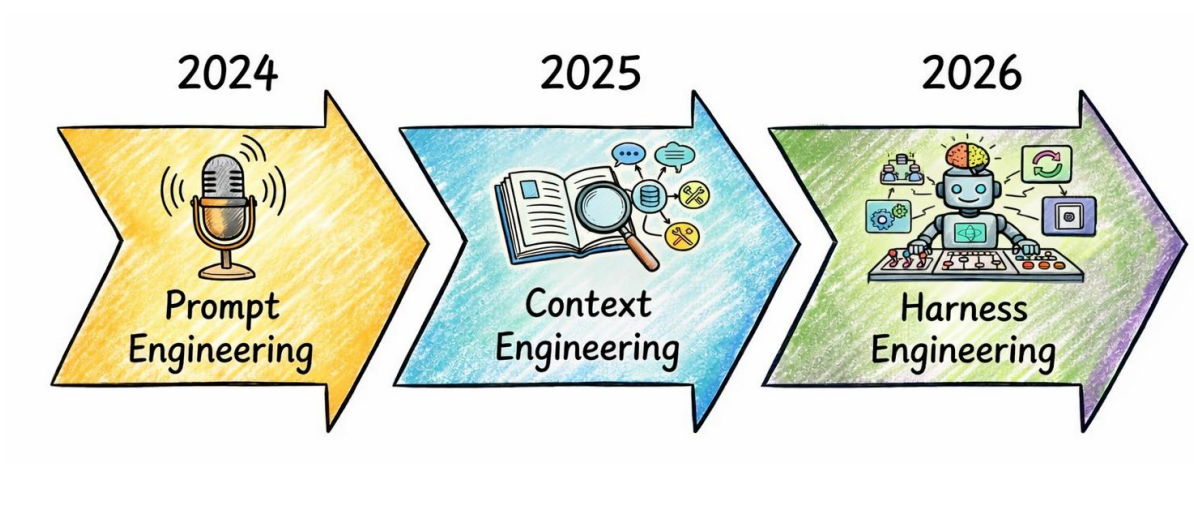
From Prompts to Agents

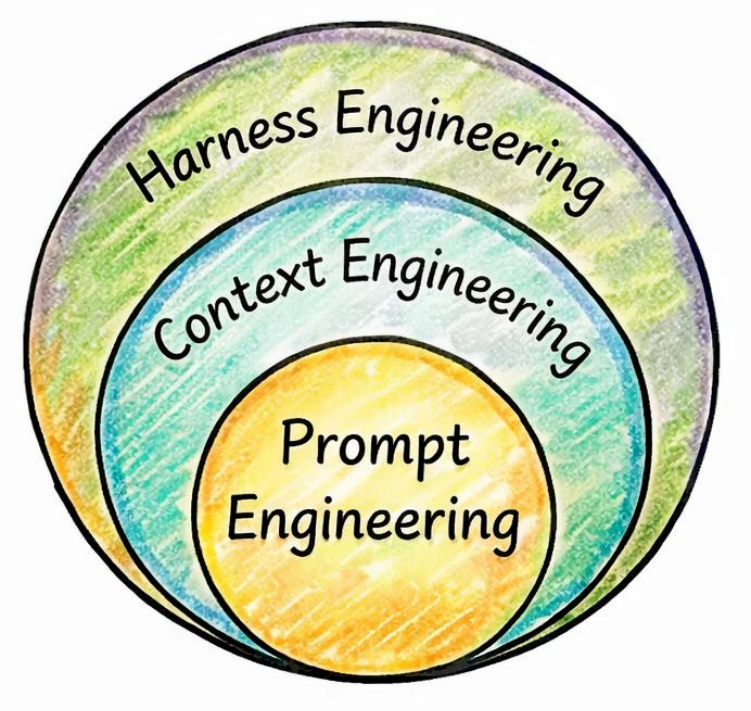
Two broader ideas for making AI
more reliable over longer work

	Context Engineering	**Harness Engineering**
核心关注	喂给模型什么信息	Agent整个运行环境设计
解决的问题	如何在有限的上下文窗口里，动态组装出最相关的“信息包”	如何构建一套系统，让Agent在长时间、复杂任务重不出错、不跑偏
工作范畴	信息选择、组织、格式化	包含约束、反馈、验证、状态管理等在内的完整系统设计
比喻	给马提供一张详细的地图和路标	为马搭建一套包含缰绳、马鞍、围栏和赛道的完整马具系统

From Prompts to Agents

AI工程范式转变





Generated by ChatGPT Thinking

From Prompts to Agents

Use the ideas, but do not get trapped by the buzzwords

- Fundamentally, these ideas all build on the same core interaction: giving AI instructions and context to improve output **quality** and **reliability**.
- Most of the newer concepts exist because current generative AI still has practical limits — inconsistent outputs, limited context, and difficulty handling longer workflows reliably.
- As models and user interfaces improve, some of these methods will become less visible or more automated for non-technical users.
- You do not need to master every term. You need to find a way of working with AI that fits your task, your standards, and your professional context.

The toolset will keep changing. Your judgment about how to work with AI is the more durable capability.

Summary

- Use the 4D framework as a guide, not a rulebook
- Match your way of working with AI to the **task**, **context**, and **level of human judgment required**
- Good AI collaboration involves more than prompting: plan the work, describe clearly, evaluate critically, and stay accountable
- Specific tools may change quickly; thoughtful and responsible use matters much more over time

AI Use Disclosure

- This session is informed by Anthropic's course – AI Fluency: Framework & Foundations, which presents the 4D framework for effective, efficient, ethical, and safe AI interaction.
- AI was used in preparing this session for idea generation, slide structuring, wording revision, and exercise adaptation.
- Final content selection, revision, and responsibility remain with the instructor.